

New normal?

IT'S BEEN NEARLY FIVE MONTHS SINCE THE WORLD GOT TURNED UPSIDE DOWN, and there's still no end in sight. A vaccine is at least five more months away, and perhaps as much as a year away, and keeping infection rates low seems to be the only way out for most countries. Most of us seem to have overcome our cabin fever to now accept this weird situation we find ourselves in as the new normal.

My in-laws, who live in Mumbai, were so outgoing and busy living life before covid that it was almost impossible to catch them at home all through the day. After the first two months of what could only have been hell for them, being locked up at home as they're both 70+, they're now used to it, and have found new ways to entertain themselves. Knowing they'd be home pretty much all the time thanks to lockdown, my wife tried calling them a few days ago, only to get no response. After repeated calls went unanswered, she was worried, and called the neighbour to ask them to check on her parents. Two minutes later the neighbour returned to say that there was very loud music playing in the house, and they could hear singing, but no one answered the door. Later, when my wife spoke to her parents, we found out they'd decided to learn some new jive steps, and were busy practicing as a way of having some fun and also getting some much needed exercise. I was in splits of laughter as my wife scolded her parents for not answering the phone, causing her to worry, and playing music so loud – how the tables have turned!

Joking aside, people all over India are doing exactly this, and being positive and focussing on all the things they just didn't have the time to do anymore. It's in our Indian DNA to always make the best of every situation, because not doing so helps no one. Thus, India is finding new ways to pass time, finding new modes of entertainment, learning new skills, and most importantly, reading books, or just reading in general! While I have no stats for India, stats for America and other countries show that people are reading a lot more, and not just online, but good old books and magazines too! That's always going to be something we cheer on excitedly.

You too can encourage this positive behaviour and get more people to read

books, and if deem it appropriate, get more people to read your favourite magazine too. We urge you to inform friends and relatives about Digit, and ask them to subscribe to either the print or digital issue, so that we can reach even more Indians, and share the many positive stories we have planned for the coming months.

Not everything is hunky dory though, and we're having a tougher than usual time getting this magazine to a few of you. You know we are not the type to try and hide our flaws, so I'd like to personally apologise to any one of you who has got the magazine late. I assure you that no matter what problems we face, we will always deliver the magazine to you, perhaps late, but without fail. Please forgive the couriers and employees of India post who are working hard through these tough times, and often have to take extra long routes to bypass a quarantined locality. Sometimes they have no option and cannot deliver the copy as there is no way for them to reach a locality that's not quarantined because it is surrounded by pin codes that are locked down. They are also stopped repeatedly by police and their credentials checked, which slows them down, and many are also short staffed, which increases the delay. Very often there is no one manning the phones at the courier or India post offices because everyone is out trying to deliver all the pending parcels!

As far as the upcoming topics go, we already have some plans in motion to bring you more DIY content, more developer-related articles and a hacking-related surprise later in the year. Aditya is doing an awesome job with the eDVD in terms of tutorials, courseware and software. The eDVD is available with the digital edition, and is available for free to all print readers of the magazine (contact help@digit.in if you don't already have access). Manish is already churning out a massive digital edition of SKOAR! every month, Mithun is taking charge of delivering more developer content and Dhriti is going to wow you with her audio reviews, and the hundreds of other things she also does. If this is the new normal for us, we're actually loving most of it... we just need to hear more often from you to make sure we're keeping you guys as happy as we are! 🇮🇳



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